

Silent Night, Holy Night

Text: Joseph Mohr, 1818;
tr. John Freeman Young, 1863
STILLE NACHT irregular

Music: Franz Gruber, 1818

The musical score is written for a guitar and four voices (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass). The guitar part is in the key of B-flat major (three flats) and 6/8 time. It features a series of chords: A-flat major (iv), E-flat major (iii), A-flat major (iv), D-flat major (iv), A-flat major (iv), D-flat major (iv), E-flat major (iii), and A-flat major (iv). The vocal parts are in four-part harmony, with the Soprano part starting on a G4 and the Bass part starting on a G3. The lyrics are in English and German, with the English lyrics in parentheses. The score is divided into four systems, each with a guitar chord diagram and a vocal line. The first system contains the first four lines of the hymn, the second system contains the next four lines, the third system contains the next four lines, and the fourth system contains the final four lines. The lyrics are: 1 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! All is calm, all is bright, 2 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Shep - herds quake at the sight, 3 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Son of God, love's pure light, 4 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Won - drous star, lend thy light, round yon vir - gin moth - er and child, ho - ly In - fant, so ten - der and mild, glo - ries stream from heav - en a - far, heav'n - ly hosts sing: "Al - le - lu - ia, ra - diant beams from Thy ho - ly face, with the dawn of re - deem - ing grace, with the an - gels let us sing, Al - le - lu - ia to our King, sleep in heav - en - ly peace, sleep in heav - en - ly peace. Christ the Sav - ior is born, Christ the Sav - ior is born." Je - sus, Lord, at Thy birth, Je - sus, Lord, at Thy birth. Christ the Sav - ior is born, Christ the Sav - ior is born.

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